Inspection Report

The Dallas World Aquarium

1801 N Griffin St
Dallas, TX 75202

Customer ID: **6545**
Certificate: **74-C-0392**
Site: 002
DWA's Avian Breeding Center

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION
Date: 20-JUL-2026

2.40(b)(2)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility is failing to maintain a program of adequate veterinary care that includes the use of appropriate methods to prevent and control diseases and injuries.

Helmeted Curassow (DWA2114/10AB114) and Many Banded Aracari (16HO11/Cage A3B #4), have moderately long nails that are overdue for a trim. Overgrown nails may impact a bird's ability to perch appropriately, which can be detrimental to their health and well-being.

Each dealer or exhibitor shall establish and maintain programs of adequate veterinary care that include the use of appropriate methods to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries.
Correct by August 31, 2026.

2.40(b)(3)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility failed to communicate the following problems of animal health to their attending veterinarian:

A Blue-Billed Curassow (2H5048) was injured by a bird in an adjacent enclosure. The bird sustained a one-inch laceration to the top part of its beak. The Blue-Billed Curassow’s injury had not been communicated to the attending veterinarian.

Prompt assessment of an animal needs to be made to minimize pain and suffering. Providing an animal with veterinary care and following the guidance of the attending veterinarian allows for the correct diagnosis to be made to better treat, control, or prevent disease. Each dealer or exhibitor shall establish and maintain programs of adequate veterinary care that include the use of appropriate methods to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries.
Correct by August 31, 2025.

3.150(e)

Facilities, general.

The facility stores bird food and supplements in a manner that does not protect them from contamination and vermin infestation. A plastic container in the food prep area holding bird supplements contained two spray bottles of cleaning

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supplies. Inspectors observed a bottle of hand sanitizer on a shelf above an open bag of bird supplement and a bottle of bleach on the same shelf with fresh fruit that was prepped for the birds. The facility is storing numerous pallets of bird feed in the Aquarium's general storage area for human food receptacles (drinking cups), fertilizer, machinery, and other equipment. Two bags of bird feed were stored directly on the floor. The current arrangement of the food among the non-food equipment and supplies makes it difficult to clean underneath and around the food pallets.
Improper storage of food and food supplements may expose them to contamination, spoilage, and vermin infestation.
Correct by storing the supplies off the floor, away from the walls and in a manner that protects the supplies from deterioration, spoilage, contamination, and vermin infestation.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.153(a)(1)(i)

Primary enclosures.

The primary enclosures for multiple species contain sharp points from the holes made in the wire fencing. In cage 1A in the indoor area containing two adult Birds of Paradise, inspectors observed a 3" by 2" hole with sharp points from the wire fencing. Cage 2 in the indoor area containing two adult Curl Crested Aracaris had a 2" by 2" hole with sharp points. Cage 3 in the indoor area containing two adult Ivory Billed Aracari had a 2" by 2" hole with sharp points. In cage 4 of the indoor area containing two adult Cocks of the Rock, inspectors observed an approximately 2" screw sticking out of the perch in front of the food and water receptacles. Cage 6 of the indoor area containing an adult Ivory Billed Aracari had a hook hanging on the enclosure with the sharp point facing towards the birds. In cage 9 of the indoor area, a zip tie above the enclosure door was cut in a manner resulting in a sharp edge. In an outdoor cage containing two adult turkeys, the enclosure wire was cut resulting in 1" sharp points. In Aviary 20, there was an enclosure containing one adult Green Aracari with two 2" by 2" holes. Aviary 17 cage 7 containing a Harpy Eagle had two wooden boards at the back left corner of the enclosure showing signs of rot with exposed nails with sharp points. In Aviary 3A cage 14 containing one Raggiana Bird of Paradise, inspectors identified a loose self-tapping screw on the floor of the enclosure and the black plastic planter for the tree was breaking apart in several areas creating sharp points.
Primary enclosures must be kept in good repair. They must be constructed and maintained so that they have no sharp points or edges that could injure the birds.
The specific sharp points listed above were corrected by the end of the inspection.

3.153(a)(1)(ii)

Primary enclosures.

The primary enclosure housing for various species of birds contained uncovered electrical outlets with exposed wires, exposed electrical wiring for the internal camera system and loose zip ties with a sharp edge. Outdoor cage 6 containing two adult Ivory Billed aracaris had camera wires hanging into their enclosure. Indoor cage 9 had loose zip ties that posed entanglement risk for the birds contained therein. Cage 1 containing two Many Banded Aracaris had a camera wire hanging into their enclosure. Outdoor cage 9 containing two adult Blue-Billed Curassows had an uncovered electrical outlet with exposed wires that was confirmed to be live. There was an exposed electrical wire in cage 7 with 2 adult Helmeted Curassows. Aviary 2, cage 17 holding two adult Black Mandible Toucans had loose zip ties that posed entanglement risk. Outside of Aviary 12, an enclosure with one adult Lettered Aracari had a loose zip tie that poses an entanglement risk. Aviary 12 cage 15 had a long live electrical wires hanging into the enclosure containing two adult Curl Crested aracaris. Cage 8 D and E in the roof top area, containing two adult Spectacled Owls had exposed live electrical wiring present above their nest box. Cage 26 with two adult Andean Cock of the Rocks and one adult Scarlett Cock of the Rock had a loose zip tie creating a large loop with approximately 2-inch diameter is an entanglement risk. In Aviary 20,

there was a cage containing two juvenile Wattled Curassows where approximately 18 inches of the wire netting covering their enclosure box had disconnected from the edges which was easily lifted by USDA inspectors during the inspection and could serve as escape or entrapment risk. Uncovered electrical outlets and the exposed wiring are safety risks to the birds that have access to them.
The primary enclosure must be constructed and maintained so that they protect the birds from injury. Correct by addressing the safety risks identified during the inspection.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.153(a)(2)

Primary enclosures.

Various perches are in a state of disrepair and are inappropriate for the species. An outdoor enclosure containing two adult Horned Screamers, an outdoor enclosure containing an adult Ocellated turkey, and an outdoor enclosure containing two adult Ocellated turkeys provided perches consisting of 2”x4” wood boards mounted so that the 2-in side was facing up. These perches are not appropriate in shape for these species.
Outdoor perimeter cage 2, containing two adult Helmeted Curassows, provided 2x2 square perches that were not appropriate in shape for this species. Aviary 8, cage 3, containing one adult Black-Necked Aracari, provided a wood dowel that had only one end securely mounted while the other had broken off and was freely moving. The rooftop enclosure 8C, containing one adult Spectacled Owl, had a wooden horizontal board that was covered in algae and showing signs of rot that could result in injury to the bird should the bird attempt to perch on the weakened wood and fall. Aviary 17 cage 5 containing an Ornate Hawk, had a standalone feeding platform that was rotting, was coming apart at the sides, and had exposed nails where the birds would be perching.
Improper perch size, shape, and texture can lead to health issues like pododermatitis and put strain on the bird’s feet and legs.

If the enclosure houses birds that rest by perching, there must be perches available that are appropriate to the age and species of the birds housed therein and a sufficient number of perches of appropriate size, shape, strength, texture and placement to comfortably hold all the birds in the primary enclosure at the same time, including birds that are ranked low in a dominance hierarchy.
Correct by September 1, 2026.

3.153(a)(3)

Primary enclosures.

An outdoor enclosure containing an adult Blue-Billed Curassow identified as 25H048 had a recent gash on its beak. Inspectors observed an adult Wattled Curassow in the enclosure adjacent to it actively attacking (striking and pecking through the fence) the Blue-Billed.
Failure to adequately screen adjacent enclosures is causing injury to the Blue-Billed Curassow.
Primary enclosures that are adjacent to one another or that share a common side with another enclosure must be suitably screened from each other or kept at a sufficient distance apart in order to prevent injury of the occupants due to predation, territorial disputes, or aggression.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.154(b)

Inspection Report

Environment enhancement to promote psychological well-being.

The facility does not have an environmental enhancement plan (EEP) approved by the attending veterinarian. Many enclosures were bare with only perches and their food receptacles present. Failure to implement and follow an EEP as approved by the attending veterinarian as outlined can negatively impact the health and well-being of the animals. Exhibitors must develop, document, and follow a species-appropriate plan for environmental enhancement that is approved by the attending veterinarian to adequately promote the psychological well-being of birds.
Correct by August 7, 2026.

3.155(a)

Feeding

Food and food supplements provided by the facility were not wholesome and free of contamination. Multiple containers of moldy papayas stored in the refrigerator intended for the use of the bird were moldy, softened, and discolored. The Wisbroek Multipro Powder bird supplement kept among the other bird supplements expired in October 2023 and was still in use. Feeding food and food supplements that is moldy, contaminated or expired may result in poor health.
The diet for birds must be wholesome, palatable, and free contamination.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.158(a)(1)

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

Inspectors observed unsanitary conditions in and around most bird enclosures and on water lines, characterized by heavy accumulation of droppings, feather dust, and old food. Many perches, bars, and enclosure floors were covered in caked-on debris. Such accumulation is detrimental to avian health. Excreta and food waste must be removed from the primary enclosures and from under and around primary enclosures as often as necessary to prevent excessive accumulation of feces and food waste, to prevent soiling of the birds contained in the primary enclosure, and to reduce disease hazards, insects, pests, and odors.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.158(c)

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility is storing boxes of drinking cups for the aquarium in front of and on top of feed bags. Employees' personal items [medications, condiments, snacks, drinks] were scattered throughout the kitchen area and the indoor storage areas. The upper-level storage areas had a disarray of transport cages among boxes of receipts, paperwork, and other random equipment, and there were excessive spiderwebs in those areas. There were accumulations of wood panels, metal panels, metal pipes and PVC pipes adjacent to several outdoor enclosures.
Failure to keep premises where housing facilities are located clean and in good repair may cause injury to the birds and does not facilitate the required husbandry practices.
Premises where housing facilities are located, including buildings, surrounding grounds, and exhibit areas, must be kept clean and in good repair in order to protect the birds from injury and disease, to facilitate the husbandry practices required in this subpart, and to reduce or eliminate breeding and living areas for rodents, pests, and vermin.
Correct by August 18, 2026.

3.158(d)

Inspection Report

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility's current program for the control of insect and mammalian pests is ineffective.
Inspectors observed numerous cockroach bodies throughout the main building, in the delivery area for food and supplies and under the cabinets and storage shelves in the kitchen, and throughout the walkways between the bird enclosures. Cage 11 containing one geriatric Resplendent Quetzal in the main building [the last enclosure at the end of the walkway] had a large accumulation of dead cockroaches on the floor of the enclosure. Inspectors observed live and dead cockroaches throughout most outdoor bird enclosures, including behind the windowpane of the parrot enclosures. The walk-in fridge containing flamingo feed had a vast amount of dead cockroaches. When inspectors opened the fridge door, several bodies fell out.

Inspectors observed a dead mouse in several enclosures including, outdoor enclosure 17 with a Blue-Throated Toucanette, aviary 8 containing various parrot species, and aviary 3 near cage 5 containing one Lesser bird of paradise. . The outdoor enclosures for Horned Curassows behind the veterinary clinic had evidence of rodent activity throughout the substrate in the form of various tunnels and openings in the substrate of their enclosure floors. The walk-in fridge containing flamingo food had a deceased mouse present on the floor. Rodent feces were seen throughout the veterinary clinic, the upper-level storage area for the flamingo feed, Aviary 20, and within the seals for the washer/dryer. Inspectors observed rodent nests throughout the veterinary clinic and unused secondary kitchen ventilation ducts.
Ants were present throughout the kitchen where employees were actively prepping food for the birds. Extensive numbers of ants were present in the fresh food, on food receptacles, and throughout enclosures for a vast majority of the outdoor bird enclosures.
Although the facility sets traps and sprays, the current program is not effective as evidenced by the findings above. Pests such as rodents, cockroaches and ants can adversely affect the health and well-being of the birds by spreading disease and contaminating food, surfaces and animal housing areas. A safe and effective program for the control of insects, ectoparasites, and avian and mammalian pests shall be established and maintained.
Correct by August 18, 2026.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

You may appeal all or part of any inspection report by submitting a written statement contesting the findings—along with any supporting documentation—to the Deputy Administrator. Appeals of routine, focused, or attempted inspections must be received within 21 days of report issuance as shown by the signature line of this report.

Appeals may be sent by email to AnimalCare@usda.gov.

Appeals sent by mail should be addressed to:
Deputy Administrator
APHIS Animal Care (AC)
U.S. Department of Agriculture
2150 Centre Avenue, Building B
Mailstop #3W11
Fort Collins, CO 80526-8117

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Date: 06-OCT-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative
Date: 06-OCT-2026

Inspection Report

Additional Inspectors:

E RODRIGUEZ, VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

CODY YAGER, Avian Field Specialist

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Date: 06-OCT-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative

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United States Department of Agriculture
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service

Customer: 6545
Inspection Date: 20-Jul-2026

Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
6545	74-C-0392	002	DWA's Avian Breeding Center	20-JUL-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000007	*Ramphastos sulfuratus*	KEEL-BILLED TOUCAN
000024	*Pteroglossus beauharnaisii*	CURL-CRESTED ARACARI
000009	*Pteroglossus bailloni*	SAFFRON TOUCANET
000012	*Pteroglossus torquatus*	COLLARED ARACARI
000003	*Pharomachrus mocinno*	RESPLENDENT QUETZAL
000020	*Pteroglossus castanotis*	CHESTNUT-EARED ARACARI
000030	*Pteroglossus inscriptus*	LETTERED ARACARI
000004	*Ramphastos toco*	TOCO TOUCAN
000011	*Aulacorhynchus haematopygus*	CRIMSON-RUMPED TOUCANET
000010	*Ramphastos dicolorus*	RED-BREASTED TOUCAN
000007	*Coracias cyanogaster*	BLUE-BELLIED ROLLER
000020	*Pteroglossus aracari*	BLACK-NECKED ARACARI
000009	*Paradisaea minor*	LESSER BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000020	*Pteroglossus pluricinctus*	MANY-BANDED ARACARI
000006	*Selenidera maculirostris*	SPOT-BILLED TOUCANET
000033	*Rupicola rupicola*	GUIANAN COCK-OF-THE-ROCK
000010	*Rupicola peruvianus*	ANDEAN COCK-OF-THE-ROCK
000011	*Paradisaea raggiana*	RAGGIANA BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000001	*Pharomachrus auriceps*	GOLDEN-HEADED QUETZAL
000003	*Ptilinopus magnificus*	WOMPOO FRUIT-DOVE
000004	*Anhima cornuta*	HORNED SCREAMER
000029	*Pteroglossus viridis*	GREEN ARACARI
000012	*Cicinnurus magnificus*	MAGNIFICENT BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000018	*Pteroglossus azara*	IVORY-BILLED ARACARI
000003	*Nothocrax urumutum*	NOCTURNAL CURASSOW
000009	*Amazona oratrix*	YELLOW-HEADED PARROT / YELLOW-HEADED AMAZON / DOUBLE YELLOW-HEADED AMAZON
000014	*Meleagris ocellata*	OCELLATED TURKEY
000001	*Psophia crepitans*	GRAY-WINGED TRUMPETER
000002	*Ara macao*	SCARLET MACAW
000002	*Aburria aburri*	WATTLED GUAN
000017	*Pauxi pauxi*	HELMETED CURASSOW / NORTHERN HELMETED CURASSOW
000003	*Perissocephalus tricolor*	CAPUCHINBIRD
000009	*Crax alberti*	BLUE-BILLED CURASSOW
000003	*Seleucidis melanoleucus*	TWELVE-WIRED BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000004	*Cicinnurus regius*	KING BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000013	*Argusianus argus*	GREAT ARGUS
000016	*Crax globulosa*	WATTLED CURASSOW
000002	*Tauraco leucolophus*	WHITE-CRESTED TURACO
000002	*Ara glaucogularis*	BLUE-THROATED MACAW
000001	*Pharomachrus antisianus*	CRESTED QUETZAL
000012	*Pulsatrix perspicillata*	SPECTACLED OWL
000004	*Spizaetus ornatus*	ORNATE HAWK-EAGLE
000002	*Spizaetus tyrannus*	BLACK HAWK-EAGLE
000001	*Strix varia*	BARRED OWL
000001	*Harpia harpyja*	HARPY EAGLE
000006	*Deroptyus accipitrinus*	RED-FAN PARROT
000007	*Aulacorhynchus sulcatus*	GROOVE-BILLED TOUCANET

Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
6545	74-C-0392	002	DWA's Avian Breeding Center	20-JUL-2026

000002	*Paradisaea rubra*	RED BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000019	*Ramphastos ambiguus*	YELLOW-THROATED TOUCAN
000010	*Cissa hypoleuca*	INDOCHINESE GREEN-MAGPIE / YELLOW-BREASTED MAGPIE
000004	*Trogon viridis*	GREEN-BACKED TROGON
000002	*Tauraco fischeri*	FISCHER'S TURACO
000001	*Corythaeola cristata*	GREAT BLUE TURACO
000004	*Oreophasis derbianus*	HORNED GUAN
000018	*Ramphastos vitellinus*	CHANNEL-BILLED TOUCAN
000001	*Gallicolumba luzonica*	LUZON BLEEDING-HEART
000018	*Starnoenas cyanocephala*	BLUE-HEADED QUAIL-DOVE
000002	*Zenaida graysoni*	SOCORRO DOVE
000013	*Coua caerulea*	BLUE COUA
000002	*Buceros rhinoceros*	RHINOCEROS HORNBILL
000003	*Aulacorhynchus coeruleicinctis*	BLUE-BANDED TOUCANET
000011	*Pteroglossus bitorquatus*	RED-NECKED ARACARI
000002	*Aulacorhynchus derbianus*	CHESTNUT-TIPPED TOUCANET
000006	*Melanerpes cruentatus*	YELLOW-TUFTED WOODPECKER
000002	*Querula purpurata*	PURPLE-THROATED FRUITCROW
000002	*Tockus kempi*	WESTERN RED-BILLED HORNBILL
000006	*Ramphastos tucanus*	WHITE-THROATED TOUCAN / RED-BILLED TOUCAN

000575 **Total**